LITTLE WONDERS ESL

History Word Lab: Ancient Greece

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · democracy and the first Olympic Games



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. I am the capital of Greece today. The Parthenon is in me.
2. In this system, citizens vote to make decisions.
3. We are sports Games that began in Ancient Greece and still take place every four years.

2 COOL FACT: THE HOME OF DEMOCRACY

Ancient Greece was a group of city-states, such as **Athens** and Sparta. The Greeks started the **Olympic Games** in 776 BCE, at Olympia, to honour the god **Zeus**. Athletes competed in running, wrestling and chariot races. Athens was the home of **democracy**, a system where citizens **vote** on laws. At that time, only some people, adult men who were citizens, could vote. The Greeks built beautiful **temples**, such as the Parthenon in Athens, and they wrote plays for the theatre.

city-state = a city that governs itself

chariot = a light vehicle pulled by horses

honour = to show respect for someone

citizens = people who belong to a city or a country

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

O	C	D	E	M	O	C	R	A	C	Y	V
R	O	T	C	O	S	P	A	R	T	A	O
O	R	L	C	L	O	A	A	C	B	U	T
T	A	Z	K	Y	O	T	E	M	P	L	E
E	M	E	W	M	T	H	E	C	A	L	L
F	I	U	B	P	T	H	E	A	T	R	E
I	O	S	W	I	C	A	O	P	O	N	A
R	S	X	B	C	D	A	T	H	E	N	S

WORD BANK

- ☐ **Athens**
- ☐ **democracy**
- ☐ **Olympic**
- ☐ **Sparta**
- ☐ **Zeus**
- ☐ **temple**
- ☐ **vote**
- ☐ **theatre**

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. Where did the Olympic Games begin?
2. What is democracy?
3. Who could vote in Ancient Athens?